BILLY FERGUSON

Personal Website
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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

University of California, Berkeley *2025 - present*
S.V. Ciriacy-Wantrup Postdoctoral Fellow
Department of Agricultural & Resource Economics

EDUCATION

Stanford Graduate School of Business *2019 - 2025*
PhD in Economic Analysis and Policy
Committee: Ali Yurukoglu, Paul Milgrom, and Lanier Benkard.

Stanford University *2015 - 2019*
BS in Mathematics

PUBLICATIONS

1. "Market Design for Surface Water" with Paul Milgrom. *New Directions in Market Design*, NBER Volume. *February 2026*
2. "What Explains Temporal and Geographic Variation in the Early US Coronavirus Pandemic?" with Hunt Allcott, Levi Boxell, Jacob Conway, Matthew Gentzkow, and Benny Goldman. *Review of Economic Design (29). December 2024.*
3. "Estimating Experienced Racial Segregation in US Cities using Large-Scale GPS Data" with Susan Athey, Matthew Gentzkow and Tobias Schmidt. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences. 118(46). November 2021.*

WORKING PAPERS

4. "Local Control over Trade: Evidence from Water Market Integration" (JMP) with Zane Kashner.
5. "Regulatory Burden and Externalities in Surface Water Markets". Submitted.
6. "Carbon Taxes, Carbon Border Adjustments, and the World Trade Organization" with Robert Staiger and Ali Yurukoglu.
7. "Assessing the Sensitivity of Synthetic Control Treatment Effect Estimates to Misspecification Error" with Brad Ross. (Reject and Resubmit at *The Review of Economics and Statistics*).

WORKS IN PROGRESS

8. "Conservation Auctions under Nested Governance" with Bing Liu.
9. "Scaling Markets to Restore the Salt Lake" with Brigham Daniels, Eric Edwards, Dustin Garrick, Bryan Leonard, Paul Milgrom, Sarah Null, and Andrew Vogt.

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

S.V. Ciriacy-Wantrup Postdoctoral Fellow

Stanford Doerr School of Sustainabiliy Accelerator Grant

Gerald H. Blum Fellowship

Gustav H. Benkendorf and Elizabeth Benkendorf Scholarship

The Institutional Venture Partners Fellowship

Stanford in Government Stipend

Undergraduate Advising and Research Major Grant

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2027: AERE/ASSA Land, Water, and Agriculture in a Changing Climate (Forthcoming)

2026: AEA/ASSA Spatial Environmental Economics Session, NBER EEE Spring Session, Chicago Booth Market Design Conference, World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists, NBER EEE Summer Institute, Kansas State Agricultural Economics (Forthcoming), UBC Food and Resource Economics

2025: Wharton BEPP Applied Economics Workshop, NYU Stern Economics, Harvard Economics, Yale Economics, UC Berkeley ARE, Washington University in St. Louis, University of North Carolina - Chapel Hill, UC Davis Groundwater Markets Workshop

2024: Advancing Sustainable Water Management Conference at Stanford, Columbia Business School DRO, Law of the Colorado River Conference

REFEREE SERVICE

Quarterly Journal of Economics, AER: Insights, Journal of Public Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, JPE Micro, Review of Economic Dynamics, Journal of Institutional Economics, Nature Sustainability, ACM Conference on Economics and Computation

PERSONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: USA
Language: English